



Colliding galaxies

This pair of interacting galaxies, collectively named Arp 273, is around 300 million light-years from Earth in Andromeda. Arp 273 reveals the early stages of a galactic merger. One of the larger galaxy's spiral arms is already unwinding into space, while the smaller galaxy is undergoing an intense burst of star formation, creating "super star clusters" that will evolve over time into globular clusters.